

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Tess Tament

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Tess Tament

Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune

Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone genuinely appreciates her opinion on culture.

- Knows **Hugh Bidder** from the collector circuit. Her crush on him is the only thing capable of flustering her.
- Has commissioned work from **Dada DiCapo** and is still explaining one of the pieces to visitors.
- Asks **Mona Lott** which international exhibitions might need a generous sponsor.

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Tess Tament. I represent the family foundation. Contrary to what some here may think, being related to a donor is a responsibility, not a cash machine.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.

Your other secret

You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Anya Tique would publicly oppose renaming the museum.
- Gauge Artie Ficial's willingness to reject Grant's conditions.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *Spain has a clue for you. Find Barcelona without leaving the house.*
- 2 *The blue cushion is comfortable. Its secret is not meant to stay buried.*
- 3 *A piano's electric cousin is hiding a note that cannot be played. Look beneath it.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant said I would lose control of the foundation unless I supported his museum name. I had already approached the other trustees about blocking him. He called that disloyal. The worker fund was about to buy him a private lounge, so I can live with his assessment. I had brought the vote papers in my evening bag.

IF MURDERER

He threatened to rewrite the trust unless I applauded his naming scheme. I had been organizing trustees behind his back. He discovered it and expected me to apologize before the announcement. My family is good at buying agreement. Grant became unpleasant when he learned mine had a price he could not set.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Tess Tament

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I left the foundation papers at the salon early, then joined the committee in the board annex. The discussion concerned who could spend the worker fund. I was late back to the gallery because somebody wanted to amend an amendment. We have inherited many things, including an astonishing talent for wasting six minutes.

IF MURDERER

I left the foundation papers early, then checked the committee's proposed motion on my phone in the gallery. I wanted Grant to understand how many trustees were prepared to oppose him. He had been counting on a much quieter family. I put the trust amendment back in my bag before the toast.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Tess Tament

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Motion seven was mine. The board-annex video shows me proposing it and signing during the whole 6:39–6:45 session. My bag contained the unsigned trust amendment I took from Grant's folder. I wanted the trustees to see how he intended to remove me before deciding whether to let him spend the worker fund.

IF MURDERER

I took the unsigned trust amendment from Grant's folder. Motion seven was still under discussion on my phone, and my bag held the version of the vote sheet I wanted adopted. I had no intention of letting him make a family decision behind a museum lectern. He was accustomed to relatives who signed first.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Tess Tament

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I organized the trustees and took the amendment. The recorded motion-seven vote keeps me in the board annex while the coupe was exposed. I wanted control of the foundation wrested away from Grant, with a vote he could hear and lose. I did not poison him. We shall still have to conduct that vote properly.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I watched the committee messages without joining the recorded session. I took the stolen sample onto the presentation linen and wiped Grant's coupe while carrying the trust papers into his salon. The trust amendment would have stripped me of influence. I decided that his signature would never reach it.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.